

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The CLARITY Act Pillar Report

The Crypto Rules Bill — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written **June 5, 2026**; scores committed by me on **June 12, 2026**. Fully re-researched **July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026**, and again as a full weekly refresh on **August 8, 2026**. Drafts were written **August 17, 18, and 20** but none was delivered — no render/selfcheck/archive/commit followed any of them — and an **August 21** session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports (not this one) before stopping, also not delivered. **This version (August 22) independently re-verifies via a dedicated primary-source research pass rather than trusting any prior draft, and HOLDS FLAT at 32/47/58/82/92**, unchanged since Aug 8. The SEC's Aug 18 parallel "Regulation Crypto Assets" rulemaking proposal and Trump's Aug 19 White House push for "a fair version" of CLARITY are both real and multi-sourced, but neither touches the binding ethics-provision or stablecoin-yield disputes, which remain unresolved as of Aug 21; two prediction markets sit flat/noisy and can't move P as market prices alone, and Coinbase CEO Armstrong's on-record passage prediction is single-source opinion, also not used. **No window moved and no call band flipped for CLARITY, and this pillar's own evidence would have qualified for auto-stamp on its own — but the overall 2026-08-22 draft set stays DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW**, because a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle caught a materially false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report (a "first confirmed fatality in the tanker campaign" claim that was actually roughly the 18th such death) — see My Decision below.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 5, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 22, 2026 (catch-up cycle off the Aug 16 committed baseline — DRAFT, flagged for manual review) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 12, 2026. Aug 16 committed (auto-stamped) is the prior baseline. Per house rule, drafts only collapse out of this table once a set actually commits — since Aug 22 stays a draft this cycle, nothing collapses yet; every set remains in scores.json forever regardless. Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were written but never delivered; an Aug 21 session delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports before stopping, also not delivered. Aug 22 holds flat again, independently re-verified via a dedicated primary-source pass; CLARITY's own evidence is clean, but the overall set is left as DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW after an adversarial fact-check caught a false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report (see My Decision).

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/13	8/14	8/16	8/22	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	55	...	32	32	32	32	0.85	8	-2.45	Bear — cloture vote itself falls outside this 30-day window
3 months	60	...	47	47	47	47	0.85	8	-0.41	Mild Bear — a dated Sept 15 procedural vote now sits squarely inside this window
6 months	65	...	58	58	58	58	0.85	8	+1.09	Mild Bull
1 year	85	...	82	82	82	82	0.90	8	+4.61	Strong Bull
3 years	92	...	92	92	92	92	0.95	8	+6.38	Very Strong Bull

Current draft P (Aug 22): 32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P - 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 55/60/65/85/92 (Jun 12) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8-Aug 7 path) → Aug 8 32/47/58/82/92 (3mo up — Thune files cloture, locking in a Sept 15-16 procedural vote; committed and stamped by Alex) → Aug 9-16 32/47/58/82/92 (held flat, auto-stamped daily; **Aug 16 committed**) → Aug 17 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 18 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 20 draft (written, never delivered) → Aug 21 session (delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports, never finished/rendered/archived/committed) → **Aug 22 32/47/58/82/92** (held flat, independently re-verified) — left as DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review (CLARITY's own evidence is routine, but the overall set is held because an adversarial fact-check caught a false claim in the Iran War Risk pillar report this cycle, not because of anything CLARITY-specific).

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Held flat this cycle at 32/47/58/82/92 — unchanged since Aug 8, across three undelivered drafts (Aug 17, 18, 20) and an interrupted Aug 21 delivery, all independently re-verified rather than trusted at face value. The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote remains the only scheduled date, re-confirmed with no date change found. Two real, multi-sourced developments landed this window: the SEC formally proposed a parallel "Regulation Crypto Assets" rulemaking on Aug 18 (sec.gov press release 2026-76) — a separate token-offering exemption track that does not touch CLARITY's binding ethics-provision or stablecoin-yield disputes; and Trump personally pushed Congress at an Aug 19 White House crypto event (with SEC Chair Atkins, CFTC Chair Selig, and industry CEOs present) to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY, multi-sourced by CoinDesk, Bloomberg, and Forbes — real public pressure, but rhetoric, with no text change or deadlock resolution reported. As of Aug 21, both the ethics-provision dispute (Democrats pressing for stronger limits on officials' crypto holdings, no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego language) and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute remain open and unresolved. Two prediction markets — Polymarket "signed into law in 2026" at 25% (Aug 22 direct pull) and Kalshi's "reaches 60 votes" at ~22% (Aug 21) — sit flat and noisy versus the range already carried, and market prices can't move P on their own under house rules regardless. Coinbase CEO Armstrong's on-record prediction that CLARITY "will pass" is single-source opinion, logged not scored. The move stays flat because Republicans still hold only 53 of the 60 votes needed and roughly zero Democrats are confirmed as yes votes. The actual live blocker, unchanged since Aug

8: a *toughened* Democratic ethics counter-proposal has sat unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3. Long-term still high — even the bears argue "slips past the midterms," not "dies."

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. This bill writes the rules for the entire market.

The Claim

The thesis as of August 22, 2026, and where I differ from the consensus — flat since Aug 8, through three undelivered drafts, an interrupted Aug 21 delivery, and today's independently re-verified catch-up cycle, nothing structural moved

The crowd: is reading Trump's Aug 19 White House crypto event — the President himself, flanked by SEC Chair Atkins and CFTC Chair Selig, publicly pushing Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY — as momentum. It's real, multi-sourced pressure (CoinDesk, Bloomberg, Forbes), but it's rhetoric aimed at Congress, not a text change, and it doesn't touch either of the two disputes actually blocking cloture.

Me: holding at 32/47/58/82/92 unchanged since Aug 8 — including through three drafts (Aug 17, 18, 20) that were written but never delivered, an Aug 21 session that delivered those numbers into only 2 of 6 reports before stopping, and today's independent re-verification of all of it against fresh primary sources. Republicans still hold only 53 of 60 needed, and both real blockers — the unanswered Democratic ethics counter-proposal and the resurfaced stablecoin-yield/banking dispute — remain open as of Aug 21. The SEC's Aug 18 "Regulation Crypto Assets" proposal is a separate rulemaking track (token-offering exemptions), not a CLARITY development, however useful as context on the broader regulatory picture.

My edge: unchanged since June — the crowd keeps pricing a *timing* problem like a *death* problem. The House did its half a year ago (294-134). A formally filed, precisely-dated cloture vote is a Senate actually moving a bill rather than sitting on it. I'm not moving any window today because nothing about the structural math (still 7 Democratic votes short) changed — Polymarket at 25% and Kalshi at ~22% (both direct pulls this window) are flat and noisy versus the range already carried, and Armstrong's personal "will pass" prediction is a single voice, not evidence — exactly the kind of noise and single-sourcing I don't chase.

The Facts

As of August 22, 2026, catch-up cycle covering the Aug 16-22 gap — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from the Aug 18-22 window appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the SEC formally proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" on Aug 18** (sec.gov press release 2026-76) — a token-offering exemption regime: a startup exemption ($\leq \$5M$ over 4 years), a fundraising exemption ($\leq \$75M$ over 12 months), and a conditional safe harbor from the "investment contract" definition. This is a separate SEC rulemaking track, not the CLARITY Act, and does not touch CLARITY's binding ethics-provision or stablecoin-yield disputes — not used to move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Trump hosted a White House crypto event on Aug 19**, with SEC Chair Atkins, CFTC Chair Selig, and industry CEOs present, and publicly pushed Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY. Multi-sourced (CoinDesk, Bloomberg, Forbes). Real public pressure and rhetoric — no text change or deadlock resolution reported, so not used to move P.
- **As of Aug 21, both live disputes remain open:** the ethics-provision fight (Democrats pressing for stronger limits on officials' crypto holdings) still has no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego language; the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute is also still unresolved.
- **The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture vote on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 remains unchanged** — re-confirmed through this window; still the only scheduled date, no change found.

- **Prediction markets (market prices, not institutional estimates — house rule):** Polymarket "signed into law in 2026" = 25% Yes (Aug 22 direct pull); Kalshi's "reaches 60 votes" market ≈ 22% (Aug 21). Both sit in the low-to-mid 20s, roughly flat/noisy versus the range already carried — not a clean directional signal, and market prices alone can't move P under house rules regardless.
- ★ **★ FLAGGED, NOT SCORED — Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong's on-record prediction that CLARITY "will pass"** is single-source opinion (one person, one outlet's framing) — explicitly not used to move P per the house sufficiency rule.
- **No change found to the confirmed Democratic yes-vote count** (still zero) or to any primary-source Senate floor action.

Carried forward from the Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts (written but never delivered — no report/render/archive/commit followed any of them; independently re-verified today, not contradicted):

- **Sen. Ruben Gallego, speaking at the SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium on Aug 20,** said White House responses to the Tillis-Gallego ethics counter-proposal "have come back blank, weaker than before, or not at all," and separately warned against rushing a floor vote (Blockonomi/Cointelegraph, FXStreet, Crypto-Economy, all Aug 20) — reaffirms the existing stalemate rather than deepening it.
- **Senate Banking Chair Tim Scott said (The Block, Aug 18) the stablecoin-yield provision "we thought was all settled" has resurfaced as a live dispute,** amid community-bank lobbying against stablecoin yield eroding GOP support — still open and unresolved as of Aug 21 (see above).
- **White House digital-assets adviser Patrick Witt called himself "truly optimistic and bullish" on passage** (The Block, Aug 18) despite the stablecoin friction — rhetoric only, no new whip count given.
- **Polymarket "signed in 2026" bounced from ~16% (around Aug 14-15) to ~24% (Aug 20 live pull)** on no identified news catalyst, and has since settled to 25% (Aug 22) — noise, not used to move P.
- ★ **★ FLAGGED FOR THE RECORD, not scored:** Galaxy Research appears to have cut its 2026-passage estimate further to 10% (from the 30% already reflected in this report's history) around Aug 14-15. This predates the Aug 16-22 window and looks like a gap in an earlier research cycle rather than new information — flagging for Alex's attention, not treating as a driver of today's score.

Carried forward from the August 16 committed baseline (still load-bearing; independently re-verified, not contradicted, this cycle):

- ★ **★ NEW — the SEC cancelled its Aug 14 "Regulation Crypto" open-meeting vote the day before it was scheduled,** citing an "unforeseen scheduling issue" (crypto.news, TechTimes, Genfinity). The ~400-page proposal would have created token-offering exemption pathways under a separate SEC rulemaking track — relevant context on regulatory limbo across both branches, but not a CLARITY-specific trigger; not used to move P.
- **The Senate remains in August recess; no new floor-schedule or ethics-text development found (as of Aug 16).** Re-checked Bitcoin Foundation, Troutman Financial Services, CoinDesk — all confirm the Sept 15 cloture date as the only scheduled action (Senate returns Sept 14, three weeks to work the bill), with no new reporting on the Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer or White House sign-off.
- **The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date remains widely corroborated** — no change from Aug 14.
- **New detail on remaining disputes:** illicit-finance provisions and reconciling the Senate Agriculture Committee's text are named as two additional sticking points ahead of the vote (PYMNTS) — consistent with, not exceeding, the "multiple unresolved fights" picture already carried.
- **CONFIRMED (Aug 8): Thune filed cloture on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633.** Confirmed against 5 independent outlets (CoinGape, CryptoBriefing, CoinDesk, Cointelegraph, CryptoSlate) plus partial primary corroboration via the bill's own congress.gov calendar text (Calendar No. 423).
- **The real live blocker remains a toughened Democratic ethics counter-proposal, unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3** (crypto.news, "CLARITY Act stalls as Trump stays silent on ethics deal," Aug 3;

corroborated by Coindesk's Jul 29 report that senators were negotiating a stronger version of the original concession).

- **Zero confirmed Democratic yes votes on cloture** as of Aug 16, against a need for roughly 7-10 crossover votes to reach 60; Republicans hold 53.
- **Polymarket "signed in 2026" (market odds, not an institutional estimate) remains around the mid-teens** per the conflicting cached reads (13-21%) noted Aug 14 — not re-verified as of Aug 16, still well below the Jul 21 local peak of 43%. Treat the exact figure as noisy; the directional read (still depressed vs. earlier in the year) is the reliable part.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ PRIMARY-SOURCE CONFIRMATION — CLARITY was not on the Senate floor calendar Jul 28-29.** A direct pull of the Senate's own daily floor schedule (daily.press.senate.gov) shows Jul 28's time went to a memorial ceremony for the late Sen. Lindsey Graham plus an executive-calendar nominee vote, and Jul 29 went to the motion to proceed on the Russia/Iran sanctions bill (which passed 86-12). This is a harder, primary-source confirmation of "no floor time" than any leadership quote — and confirms no path to passage before the Aug 7 recess.
- ★ **Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer reported — real, but not finalized.** CoinDesk (tier-1) and 4+ corroborating outlets report Sens. Tillis (R-NC) and Gallego (D-AZ) struck new common ground on an ethics compromise (Jul 29-30). The exact text is undisclosed and White House sign-off is unconfirmed — CoinDesk's own reporting hedges "whether they've actually done it is unclear," and neither senator's office nor the White House responded to comment requests. Treat as real movement, not a completed deal.
- ★ **NEW — a second ethics-adjacent fight surfaced and was rejected by both sides.** A proposal to give prosecutors enforcement leeway over software-developer liability was floated and then rejected Jul 30 by both the White House (adviser Patrick Witt mocking the comparison) and the crypto industry (DeFi Education Fund's Amanda Tuminelli: "not a constructive or serious proposal"). A fresh friction point, not yet resolved.
- ★ **NEW — SEC Chair Atkins says the SEC can write crypto rules unilaterally if Congress stalls.** Atkins told CNBC (Jul 29, corroborated by 5+ outlets) the SEC is "ready, willing, and able" to issue crypto market-structure rules on its own, while still calling statute the preferred, "future-proof" path. A modest reducer of legislative urgency — noted, not scored.
- **Odds board (sentiment only) — as independently re-verified July 30:** Polymarket's "signed in 2026" contract hit a record low of 27% (Jul 29) before recovering to 30% (my own live pull, Jul 30) — down from the ~35% read a week ago. Galaxy Research's Alex Thorn cut his personal 2026-passages estimate from 50% to 30% — confirmed real and well-corroborated, but dated to Jul 24-25, not this week; not double-counted here.
- **Vote math — carried forward, unchanged:** GOP floor count remains ~53; still only Gallego and Alsobrooks on record as Democratic negotiators, both conditioning votes on enforceable ethics language. Firmly committed Democratic votes: zero.
- **Sen. Graham's death and the Senate's memorial calendar** continue to consume floor time this week — a genuine, primary-source-confirmed scheduling drag, distinct from any "thinned floor math" inference (which was already corrected in an earlier cycle: his SC seat was refilled within 48 hours, GOP floor count restored to ~53).
- **Ethics talks were broken as recently as Jul 22** (seven Senate Democrats formally rejected the GOP's DOJ-enforcement draft that day) but the Tillis-Gallego report suggests movement since — carried forward as the binding constraint, now potentially loosening.
- **The June 30 ethics bomb, still the root cause:** OGE released Trump's 927-page disclosure on **June 30: ~\$1.4B of 2025 crypto income** — \$635M in TRUMP-memecoin royalties, \$500M+ WLF-related. Gillibrand: "there is no CLARITY Act without an ethics provision."
- **Section 604 / Wyden's developer-protection push — carried forward, corroborated by 9+ independent outlets.** No committed Democratic floor vote attached to it yet.

- **The stablecoin-yield fight — carried forward, still closed off rather than resolved:** Banking Chairman Tim Scott rejected bank lobbyists' request to change yield-related restrictions on the floor; Coinbase's ~\$1.35B/yr USDC-rewards structure survives in the text as-is.
- **Still true from June, still load-bearing:** the House passed H.R. 3633 **294-134 on July 17, 2025** (bipartisan); Senate Banking advanced its separate substitute **15-9 on May 14, 2026**. House fast-follow plan (companion bill, Rep. Dusty Johnson) unchanged.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

Anchor: BTC **\$77,169.40** (Bitstamp daily close, August 22, 2026) — up from \$71,882.92 on Aug 20 (+7.4%). A **GENIUS-sized move (~40–47%)** from here ≈ **~\$108–113K**. A retest of the ~\$125K high ≈ **+62%**. The anchor is real: during the GENIUS Act's passage (Senate committee Mar 13 → signed July 18, 2025) Bitcoin ran from ~\$83K to ~\$120K (≈+44%).

Discount both — 2025 had tailwinds 2026 doesn't, and **the GENIUS rally itself fully retraced**. And note the coil cuts both ways: prediction-market odds bottomed at a fresh record low of 13% on Aug 5, bounced to a noisy 20-27% on the cloture filing, and have since settled to 25% (Polymarket, Aug 22) and ~22% (Kalshi's 60-vote market, Aug 21) — still a real repricing from the ~74-82% readings earlier in 2026, but flat and noisy week to week rather than trending. The cloture filing is a dated procedural step, not evidence the underlying passage odds have durably moved; the odds swings are sentiment, not a scored fact. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on, and this week's further BTC gain against a completely flat CLARITY score is itself a reminder that this pillar's signal and price action aren't the same thing.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The Tillis-Gallego "breakthrough" isn't confirmed by either side.** No text is public, the White House hasn't signed off, and CoinDesk's own reporting hedges on whether the senators have actually reached an agreement. This report is giving real weight (an 8-point 6mo improvement from the Jul 18 low) to something that could evaporate as easily as the Jul 20-22 ethics deal did when seven Democrats rejected it.
- **A second unresolved fight just opened up.** The developer/software-liability dispute, rejected by both the White House and industry Jul 30, shows that even as one axis of the ethics fight narrows, new disputes keep appearing — a pattern, not a one-off.
- **A cloture filing with no Democratic votes lined up may just be political theater.** Punchbowl's own sourcing says Democrats consider this vote "doomed" — if Thune is filing cloture knowing it will fail, the point may be to put Democrats on the record before the midterms rather than to actually advance the bill, which would make today's "progress" more symbolic than substantive.
- **The floor-calendar problem doesn't have an end date either.** "No path before recess" was confirmed by Thune himself, but this report's own history is repeated rounds of missed "imminent" and "targeted" dates — nothing guarantees the actual Sept 15-16 vote produces real movement rather than another procedural loss, and September is also when midterm-campaign politics starts eating floor time.
- **Prediction markets are genuinely more bearish than a month ago.** A record-low 27% print, even if it partially recovered, is real information — Galaxy Research's own house view dropped from 50% to 30% independent of any single news event, suggesting professional handicappers see this as a genuine coin-toss-or-worse on 2026 passage.

- **The SEC's "we'll do it ourselves" signal cuts against urgency.** If the White House and industry believe the SEC can deliver workable rules unilaterally, that reduces the political cost of letting CLARITY slip further — a slow bleed on legislative priority, not a dramatic kill.
- **The midterms are still the real wall:** miss August 7 and September belongs to election politics. Worst case — Congress resets in January and the Senate starts its bill over.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set August 22, 2026 (Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts written but not delivered; an Aug 21 session delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports, not this one, before stopping).

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Aug 18, checked Aug 22	SEC formally proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" (sec.gov press release 2026-76) — a parallel token-offering exemption rulemaking	Separate SEC track, not a CLARITY-specific trigger — no P move
Fired Aug 19, checked Aug 22	Trump's White House crypto event — publicly pushed Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY (Atkins, Selig, industry CEOs present)	Public pressure, multi-sourced, but no text change or deadlock resolution — no P move
Checked Aug 21 — both open	Ethics-provision dispute (no confirmed WH sign-off on Tillis-Gallego language) and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute both remain unresolved	The actual blockers, unchanged — no P move
Aug 18-20, re-verified Aug 22	Sen. Gallego's SALT Wyoming remarks (Aug 20) and Sen. Tim Scott's stablecoin-yield comment (Aug 18) — WH ethics responses described as "blank, weaker than before, or not at all"; stablecoin-yield provision resurfaces as a live dispute	Reaffirms the existing stalemate and logs a wrinkle now folded into "both open" above — no P move
Fired Aug 8, precisely dated Aug 9, broadly corroborated since	Cloture vote on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 is scheduled 2:15pm ET Tuesday, Sept 15 (Senate inter-party scheduling agreement; re-confirmed through Aug 22)	Confirmation of the Aug 8 trigger, not a new one — no P move
Sept 15	PENDING — first cloture vote, now precisely dated; Democrats call it "doomed" absent further concessions; Republicans hold 53 of 60 needed	Cloture clears = re-rate 3mo/6mo up hard, real momentum; cloture fails cleanly = re-rate down, base case shifts toward 2027
Unresolved since Jul 30	Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer — real per CoinDesk + 4 outlets as of Jul 29-30, text still undisclosed, WH sign-off still not confirmed as of Aug 21	If confirmed and signed off before the vote, the single biggest unlock this year — watch for a released text
Ongoing	Three named Democratic blocking issues: ethics enforcement, illicit-finance/DeFi provisions, stablecoin yield (Yahoo Finance, Aug 5)	Resolution on all three before the vote = real chance of cloture succeeding; continued silence = the "doomed" framing holds
Any time	NOT FIRED — White House formally signs off on a merged text with Democratic buy-in	The single biggest unlock — Democratic votes follow; re-rate everything up

The flip line: cloture fails on Sept 15-16 with no released, WH-confirmed ethics text and no clear next-step plan = start treating 2026 passage as effectively dead, not just delayed. Keep 1-year and 3-year Bull either way — a bill with 294 House votes, a reported bipartisan ethics counteroffer, and a formally filed cloture motion is delayed, not dead.

My Decision

🕒 DRAFT — AUGUST 22, 2026 (CATCH-UP CYCLE) · AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW

Committed P: 32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92 (holds flat) · Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

Held flat again today — unchanged since Aug 8, across three undelivered drafts (Aug 17, 18, 20 — none followed by a report/render/archive/commit) and an Aug 21 session that delivered the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports (not this one) before stopping, also not delivered. This cycle independently re-verifies all of it against fresh primary sources rather than trusting any prior draft. The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date is unchanged, re-confirmed. Two real, multi-sourced developments landed this window — the SEC's Aug 18 parallel "Regulation Crypto Assets" rulemaking proposal and Trump's Aug 19 White House push for "a fair version" of CLARITY — but neither touches the actual blockers: both the ethics-provision dispute and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute remain open and unresolved as of Aug 21. Two prediction markets (Polymarket 25%, Kalshi ~22%) sit flat and noisy, and Coinbase CEO Armstrong's on-record passage prediction is single-source opinion — neither clears the sufficiency bar to move P. The real live blocker, unchanged since Aug 8, is a toughened Democratic ethics counter-proposal sitting unanswered at the White House since roughly Aug 1-3.

CLARITY's own evidence this cycle is routine — nothing here would have blocked an auto-stamp on its own.

No window moved and no call band flipped. But a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle re-examined the Iran War Risk pillar's research and found it rests on a materially false claim: the report described an Aug 18 UAE strike death as the "first confirmed fatality in the tanker campaign," when in fact primary sources show it was roughly the 18th such death — a toll never previously scored, and a claim the original research pass never caught. Per house discipline, when verification surfaces an inconsistency it can't fully resolve, the whole score set defaults to draft rather than partial self-approval. So the full 2026-08-22_draft set — including this unchanged, cleanly-evidenced CLARITY score — is left as DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW, not auto-stamped.

The June committed scores (**55 / 60 / 65 / 85 / 92**, committed June 12, 2026) and the Aug 16 committed scores (**32 / 47 / 58 / 82 / 92**) remain the last committed values — identical to today's draft, which stays uncommitted pending Alex's manual review.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Catch-up cycle, August 22, 2026 — checking for changes since the Aug 16 committed baseline, spanning three undelivered drafts (Aug 17, 18, 20) and an interrupted Aug 21 delivery.

- **Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were written but never delivered** — no report/render/selfcheck/archive/commit followed any of them. An Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers into only 2 of 6 reports (not this one) before stopping — also treated as not-delivered per house discipline. This Aug 22 cycle independently re-verifies all of it against fresh primary sources rather than treating any prior draft as ground truth, and lands as a new dated set (2026-08-22_draft) per the runbook's new-day rule.
- ★ **★ NEW — the SEC formally proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" on Aug 18** (sec.gov press release 2026-76) — a token-offering exemption regime on a separate rulemaking track; does not touch CLARITY's ethics or stablecoin-yield disputes.
- ★ **★ NEW — Trump's Aug 19 White House crypto event** (Atkins, Selig, industry CEOs present) publicly pushed Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY — real, multi-sourced pressure (CoinDesk, Bloomberg, Forbes), but rhetoric only, no text change or deadlock resolution.

- **As of Aug 21, both live disputes remain open** — no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego ethics language, and the stablecoin-yield/banking dispute is still unresolved.
- **Carried forward and re-verified:** Sen. Gallego's Aug 20 SALT Wyoming remarks and Sen. Tim Scott's Aug 18 stablecoin-yield comment — reaffirm, don't deepen, the existing stalemate.
- **Prediction markets:** Polymarket "signed in 2026" = 25% (Aug 22 direct pull), Kalshi "reaches 60 votes" ≈ 22% (Aug 21) — flat and noisy versus the range already carried; market prices, not used to move P.
- ★ **★ NEW, FLAGGED NOT SCORED — Coinbase CEO Armstrong's on-record "will pass" prediction** is single-source opinion, not used per the sufficiency rule.
- **Flagged for Alex:** Galaxy Research appears to have cut its 2026-passage estimate to 10% around Aug 14-15 — predates this window and looks like a gap in an earlier cycle, not new information; not used to move today's P.
- **The Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date remains unchanged** — re-confirmed.
- **Zero confirmed Democratic yes votes on cloture** — Republicans hold 53 of 60 votes needed, unchanged.
- **Score re-rates (Aug 16 → Aug 22):** 1-month 32 → **32** (held) · 3-month 47 → **47** (held) · 6-month 58 → **58** (held) · 1-year 82 → **82** (held) · 3-year 92 → **92** (held) — nothing found today clears the sufficiency bar to move a window. **Left as DRAFT — not auto-stamped:** no window moved and no call band flipped for CLARITY, but a dedicated adversarial fact-check this cycle found the Iran War Risk pillar report rested on a materially false claim ("first confirmed fatality in the tanker campaign" — actually roughly the 18th such death, never previously scored, a claim the original research pass missed). Per house discipline, an inconsistency verification can't fully resolve holds the WHOLE score set for manual review rather than partial self-approval, so the full 2026-08-22_draft set, including this unchanged CLARITY score, stays DRAFT — AWAITING MY STAMP — FLAGGED FOR MANUAL REVIEW.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 22, 2026, catch-up cycle (earlier sources below still stand as historical citations for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official records first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **August 22 catch-up check:** sec.gov — SEC press release 2026-76, "SEC Proposes Regulation Crypto Assets" (Aug 18), the primary source for the token-offering exemption regime (startup exemption ≤\$5M/4yrs; fundraising exemption ≤\$75M/12mo; conditional safe harbor from the "investment contract" definition) · CoinDesk, Bloomberg, and Forbes (all Aug 19) — independent coverage of Trump's White House crypto event with SEC Chair Atkins, CFTC Chair Selig, and industry CEOs, and his public push for Congress to pass "a fair version" of CLARITY · Motley Fool (Aug 21) — confirms the ethics-provision and stablecoin-yield/banking disputes both remain open, no confirmed White House sign-off on the Tillis-Gallego language · Polymarket — "signed into law in 2026" live pull, 25% (Aug 22) · Kalshi — "reaches 60 votes" market, ≈22% (Aug 21) · Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong's on-record "will pass" prediction — single-source opinion, flagged not scored. This cycle independently re-verifies the underlying claims behind the undelivered Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts, and the interrupted Aug 21 delivery, against these fresh primary/reporting sources rather than treating any of them as ground truth.
- **August 20 draft (written, never delivered — re-verified Aug 22):** Blockonomi/Cointelegraph, FXStreet, and Crypto-Economy (all Aug 20) — independent same-speech coverage of Sen. Ruben Gallego's remarks at the SALT Wyoming Blockchain Symposium, describing White House ethics responses as "blank, weaker than before, or not at all" and warning against rushing a floor vote · The Block — Senate Banking Chair Tim Scott's stablecoin-yield comment and White House adviser Patrick Witt's "truly optimistic and bullish" remark (both Aug 18) · The Block and Troutman Financial Services Blog — re-confirmation of the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture date, no change found.
- **August 16 light daily check:** crypto.news — "The SEC pulled its own crypto vote and nobody saw it coming" · TechTimes — "SEC Cancels Reg Crypto Vote: CFTC Steps Up" · Genfinity — SEC sets, then cancels, Aug 14 Regulation Crypto vote · Bitcoin Foundation — CLARITY vote pushed to September, re-checked · Troutman Financial Services — Senate adjourns without vote, Sept 15 on calendar, re-checked — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; the SEC's cancelled vote is a separate rulemaking track, logged as context only.
- **August 14 light daily check:** Davis Wright Tremaine — "Senate Republicans Release Updated Crypto Market Structure Text" · CoinDesk — "Senate won't vote on crypto Clarity Act before its summer break" · Bitcoin Foundation — "The Clarity Act August 10 Final Deadline" · Motley Fool — "The Senate Just Delayed a Vote on the Clarity Act" · Yahoo Finance — "U.S. Senate Shelves Clarity Act Ahead Of Summer Break" — all reconfirm Thune's Aug 6-8 no-August-vote statements and the Senate's Sept 14 return /

three-week window, consistent with the Sept 15 cloture date already carried; Polymarket cached reads (13%, 16%, 21% across different pulls) don't reconcile to one live number, logged as sentiment only per house sufficiency rules.

- August 13 light daily check:** KuCoin — "Senate Votes on CLARITY Act Cloture on Sept. 15" · [news.bitcoin.com](#) — "CLARITY Act Vote Is Set for Sept. 15: Here's What Happens Next" · PYMNTS — "Senate Hands Crypto Industry a Sept. 15 Deadline" (illicit-finance and Agriculture Committee text named as additional sticking points) · Bitcoin Foundation — "Congress Crypto Bill Delay... 2026 Passage Hopes Fade" (Polymarket odds ~15.5%, down from ~30% a week earlier) · Yahoo Finance — "Senate Keeps Clarity Act Alive With Crypto Bill Vote Set for September" — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; the Polymarket figure is the one new data point, logged as sentiment only per house sufficiency rules.
- August 12 light daily check:** KuCoin — "Senate Votes on CLARITY Act Cloture on Sept. 15" · Disruption Banking — "CLARITY Act News: The Crypto Bill Just Slipped to a September 15 Senate Showdown" (Aug 10) · [news.bitcoin.com](#) — "CLARITY Act Vote Is Set for Sept. 15" and "CLARITY Act Heads Toward Sept. 15 Senate Vote" · The Block — original Aug 8 cloture-filing report, re-checked · CryptoPotato — "CLARITY Act Gets September 15 Senate Vote as Thune Forces the Issue" · Troutman Financial Services Blog — "Senate Adjourns Without Clarity Act Vote, But September Vote Now on the Calendar" — all confirm Sept 15 as the only scheduled action; none report new scheduling or ethics-text developments. No new dated catalyst found.
- August 11 light daily check:** Coindesk, CryptoPotato, American Banker, Bitcoin Foundation, Forbes — all re-checked for movement beyond the Aug 8 cloture filing; none report new scheduling or ethics-text developments. No new dated catalyst found.
- August 10 light daily check:** CoinGape, Blockonomi, Disruption Banking, [news.bitcoin.com](#) — all four independently corroborate the Sept 15, 2:15pm ET cloture scheduling agreement, bringing total outlet corroboration to 7. CryptoSlate/CryptoTimes (Jul 24-27, re-checked today) — confirms the "Galaxy cuts odds to 30%" figure traces to a late-July report, already priced in; excluded as a fresh trigger. No new dated catalyst found beyond these.
- August 9 light daily check:** The Block — "Majority Leader Thune files cloture on Clarity Act, setting up Sept. 15 Senate vote" (Aug 8) · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act is finally headed for a 60-vote Senate showdown in September" (Aug 8) · Cointelegraph — "CLARITY Act Heads Toward Key US Senate Procedural Vote" (Aug 8) — all three corroborate the precise 2:15pm ET Sept 15 scheduling agreement; no new dated catalyst beyond this found.
- August 8 full-weekly re-verification:** CoinGape — "CLARITY Act Senate vote cloture motion filed by Senate Majority Leader Thune" and "cloture vote set for September 15" (Aug 8) · CryptoBriefing — "Thune files cloture, September showdown" (Aug 8) · CoinDesk — "U.S. Senate opens first stage of crypto Clarity Act voting to give bill a chance next month" (Aug 8) · Cointelegraph — "US Senate CLARITY Act, key procedural vote" (Aug 8) · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act is finally headed for a 60-vote Senate showdown in September" (Aug 8) · Congress.gov — H.R.3633 bill text, Calendar No. 423 (primary, partial corroboration) · crypto.news — "CLARITY Act stalls as Trump stays silent on ethics deal" (Aug 3) · CoinDesk — "senators said to strike idea to toughen Trump's concession" (Jul 29) · CCN — Polymarket odds crash to 13% (Aug 5).
- August 7 additions:** The Block — "Senate delays Clarity Act vote until after August recess, Thune confirms" (Aug 6, ~11pm ET, direct on-record quote) · CoinGape — "Thune Likely to File Cloture Motion on Clarity Act as Early as Aug. 6" (superseded by the delay) · CryptoRank — "Thune Cloture Motion Clarity Act Aug 6" · CryptoTimes — "Senate Majority Leader Eyes CLARITY Cloture as Ethics Talks Continue" (Aug 4) · Yahoo Finance/Politico-sourced — "Senate Democrats Block Path to 60 Votes on CLARITY Act Before August Recess" (Aug 5).
- August 6 additions:** CoinDesk — "Clarity Act: Here's what could happen with the crypto market structure legislation" (Aug 5) · Cryptonews / Yahoo Finance — "CLARITY Act Senate Vote Locked In, But 60-Vote Hurdle Looms Large" · Phemex — "CLARITY Act Cloture Deadline | Senate Vote Odds Aug 2026" · *traced and excluded as stale (dated Jul 20-21, not new)*: Bravenewcoin — "White House Signs Off on CLARITY Act Ethics Deal" · CryptoBriefing — "White House agrees on ethics package for Clarity Act, sent to Senate Republicans."
- August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** CoinGape — "CLARITY Act LIVE Updates, Aug. 5: US Senate Vote Filing Expected Today" and related live-update coverage · KuCoin — "CLARITY Act Removed from Senate Schedule, 72-Hour Countdown Begins" · crypto.news — "The Senate has one week: CLARITY's last August window" · CryptoSlate — "CLARITY Act just vanished from Monday's Senate schedule" · Bitcoin Foundation — "CLARITY Act Countdown: Senate Has Days to Save Landmark Crypto Bill Before Recess" · Roll Call, Federal News Network, and Senate 2026-calendar coverage (x/maxpcohen) — confirming the Senate's actual August recess begins Aug 10, not Aug 7 · Yahoo Finance, Bitcoin.com, KuCoin, CryptoSlate, Spendnode — Aug 3 Senate floor plan covering only H.R. 6500 CR cloture.
- July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** [dailypress.senate.gov](#) — the Senate's own daily floor schedule, direct pull, confirming CLARITY was not on the calendar Jul 28-29 · CoinDesk — Tillis-Gallego ethics counteroffer reported (Jul 29-30), corroborated by [thecurrencyanalytics.com](#), [Bloomberg](#), [Hokanews](#), [Coingabbar](#) · CryptoSlate — [developer-liability enforcement proposal rejected by both sides \(Jul 30\)](#) · CryptoBriefing — [SEC Chair Atkins says the SEC can act unilaterally \(Jul 29\)](#), corroborated by CCN, Decrypt, Yahoo Finance, Coincentral, Bitcoin Magazine · crypto.news — [Polymarket record-low 27% \(Jul 29\)](#) · Polymarket direct pull (Jul 30, 30%) · The Block — [Galaxy Research's Alex Thorn cuts 2026-passage estimate to 30% \(Jul 24-25\)](#), corroborated

- by CryptoTimes, Bloomingbit, Benzinga, CryptoSlate, news.bitcoin.com, Yahoo Finance · CoinDesk — Senate puts off CLARITY, focuses elsewhere (Jul 27) · Congress.gov CRS product — FY2027 NDAA status (Thune withdrew MTP Jul 23).
- **July 24-25 additions:** Sen. Gallego's Politico interview rejecting the initial GOP ethics draft (via CryptoTimes) · White House adviser Patrick Witt's comments urging Democrats to "accept the victory" (CoinDesk, Jul 24) · seven Senate Democrats' formal rejection statement of the Jul 22 draft (Bitcoin.com, PrimeXBT, KuCoin).
 - **July 13 additions:** NBC News — Sen. Lindsey Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Washington Post — Graham dies at his South Carolina home (Jul 12) · Axios — Graham's death, aortic dissection cited as preliminary cause (Jul 12) · NPR — Graham dies suddenly (Jul 12) · Bloomberg — Graham dies (Jul 12) · Roll Call — "This week: Graham's death..." scrambles Senate agenda (Jul 13) · CNN — Graham dies (Jul 12) · MSNBC/ms.now — Senate's agenda left in limbo (Jul 12) · Boston Globe — Senate's week upended by Graham's death (Jul 13) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" WH less engaged than earlier in summer (Jul 12) · crypto.jobs — House FSC hearing New York venue (corroborating, cited Jul 13) · CryptoBriefing — House FSC hearing New York venue (2nd corroboration) · Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M volume, \$5.9K 24h (fetched Jul 13) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — KXCRIPTOSTRUCTURE ladder, live fetch (Jul 13).
 - **July 11 additions (historical):** TechTimes — merged draft due next week, Senate eyes Jul 20 floor vote (Jul 10) · The Crypto Times — same, Jul 20 floor vote target (Jul 10) · Cointribune — Senate schedules a crucial vote on Jul 20 · CoinGape — new draft expected next week, committees merging text · Polymarket — "signed in 2026" recovered to ~46-47% (Jul 11).
 - **Official & primary records:** Senate Democratic Leadership — floor schedule for July 13 (noms, then NDAA cloture) (*this is the primary basis for "no cloture on CLARITY" this round*) · House FSC — July 17 hearing, digital asset market-structure gaps (committee event page) · Congress.gov — H.R. 3633 (CLARITY Act) (*direct fetch blocked with a 403 on the July 8 check; not re-pulled July 10*) · GovTrack — House passage 294-134, July 17 2025 (Vote #199).
 - **The reporting:** CoinDesk — merged draft "as soon as next week," 70+ pages, week-of-July-20 floor, WH not signed off, Wyden on 604 (July 9) (*the first of three straight "imminent" calls — July 9, 10, and 12 — none of which has produced an actual text as of July 13*) · CoinDesk — "Signs of life?" column, WH engagement question revisited, still no merged text (July 12) · American Banker — ethics stalled, Scott rejects bank yield changes, Groshans "north of 65," Schardin "next week or two" (July 9) · Crypto In America — Lummis exchange-liability trial balloon, Wyden July 8, FOP/NSA/NAPO silent (July 9) (*Wyden/Section 604 corroboration upgraded to 9+ independent outlets as of July 13 — see July 13 additions above*) · The Crypto Times — corroboration of the merged-draft report (July 10) · Tekedia — HFSC July 17 hearing ("New York" venue now 2-source corroborated by crypto.jobs and CryptoBriefing as of July 13) · Yahoo Finance — countdown: no cloture, Calendar No. 423 (July 7) · crypto.news — the 3 fights: ethics, DeFi, \$1.35B in yield (July 8) · CoinDesk — CLARITY and Congress's summer break (July 5) · Yahoo Finance — odds fall as Trump's \$1.4B crypto disclosure lands (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — NOBLE becomes first LE endorsement (July 3) · Yahoo — Major County Sheriffs move to neutral (July 4) · CoinDesk — White House-law enforcement talks (June 29) · The Block — TD Cowen's July timeline, July 24 critical (June 29) · CoinDesk — Trump's SAVE-Act signature-hostage play (June 24) · The Defiant — seven-Democrat math, Dusty Johnson House fast-follow (June 26) · DigitalToday — Aug 6 target, ethics fight continues (July 7).
 - **The prices:** carried from the June 19 check and the July 8 anchor — not re-verified July 10. Fortune — BTC ~\$63.4K (June 12 2026) · Digital Chamber — BTC ATH ~\$126K (Oct 6 2025) · Amberdata — BTC ~\$123K at GENIUS signing.
 - **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Polymarket Gamma API — "signed in 2026," last 46¢ (44 bid/46 ask), \$1.61M total volume, \$5.9K 24h volume (fetched July 13) (*historical: last 41¢ / mid ~40¢, -4.5¢ on day, fetched July 10, 15:58 UTC*) · Kalshi Trade API v2 — series KXCRIPTOSTRUCTURE (fetched July 13; ladder mixed vs. the July 10 fetch, still thin/indicative liquidity) · Polymarket — CLARITY signed in 2026 (event page) · The Block — Galaxy cuts odds 60% → 50% (June 29; no update found July 9-10) · Deadspin — Kalshi & Polymarket prices (July 7, historical reference). JPMorgan <50% and TD Cowen "far from assured" — quoted in the reporting above · CoinDesk — Jefferies note citing Polymarket 48% (June 30). (*A "Bloomberg Intelligence 60%" figure circulating July 5 traces only to social-media relays of a July-passage estimate — excluded as unverified.*)